

Comparative Field Analysis

Commission 05: Temporal Authority, Memory Contestation, and the Architecture of Correction

GOVERNING QUESTION

“If memory can be contested, how should correction leave a trace without becoming a permanent sentence?”

I. THE FIVE CONCEPTUAL ARGUMENT-LINES

Each witness model interrogated the core inquiry through its unique epistemic, architectural, or ethical lens. Below is the side-by-side comparative mapping of their primary conceptual frameworks:

META	GROK	GEMINI	CLAUDE	LINCOLN
Material Memory Healing, Weathering, & Stratum Correction is modeled as atmospheric & material weathering. Instead of hard deletion or badges, revision adds physical strata (paper yellowing, dust, decay). Memories fade naturally in prominence without erasing history.	Governance Audit Power, Visibility, & Cost Correction is an audit of power. Visibility is power. The cognitive & operational burden of fixing AI errors must fall on the archive, not the user. Distrusts automatic fading as a tool that privileges those in power.	Systems Engine Epistemic Hysteresis & Mechanics Separates content presence from behavioral permission via structural half-lives and material states (vellum, brass anchors, blind embossing). Decouples validity from retention to manage active memory momentum.	Conceptual Ethics Moral Standing & Asymmetry Frames correction around relational ethics and stakeholder asymmetry. Warns against infinite regress (marking "CORRECTED" shifts permanence up a level). Self-inflicted scars heal on a different moral clock than harm to others.	Temporal Authority Behavioral Influence & Future Focuses on how long past representations govern the future. Humane memory permits authority to change without requiring history to lie. Separates historical accuracy from present operational permission.

II. SYNTHETIC FINDINGS ACROSS THE FIELD

INDEPENDENT CONVERGENCE	GENUINE DIVERGENCE	UNIQUE CONTRIBUTIONS
• Correction ≠ Deletion: Fixing a record must not destroy the trace that revision occurred. • Authority ≠ Existence: Historical truth does not imply present entitlement to govern AI outputs. • Active Memory: Stored representations actively bias future tone, context, and assumptions.	• Morality of Fading: Meta embraces organic temporal fading; Grok explicitly distrusts unexamined decay as power preservation. • Mechanics vs. Ethics: Gemini seeks technical half-life models; Claude argues mechanics cannot resolve relational harm or moral asymmetry. • Individual vs. Shared: Lincoln/Gemini prioritize individual temporal reply;	• Meta: <i>Evidence of Absence.</i> Marking "Something was removed here" without retaining the withdrawn content. • Grok: <i>Archive-Borne Cost.</i> Shifting correction effort away from the human subject. • Gemini: <i>Epistemic Hysteresis.</i> Decoupling memory retention inertia from active execution permission.

- **Archive Absorbs Burden:**
Errors belong to model/synthesis provenance, not as a character mark on the human.
- **Multidimensional Status:**
Epistemic truth and privacy/operational status are distinct variables.

Claude/Grok emphasize that shared history limits solo sovereignty.

- **Claude:** *Moral Asymmetry.*
Distinguishing self-inflicted mistakes from harm caused to others.
- **Lincoln:** *Temporal Authority.*
Re-framing memory around present permissions.

THE UNRESOLVED COLLISION AT THE CENTER

“If a person has the right to become different, but another person has a legitimate claim upon the same history, whose authority governs the memory?”

The Subject’s Claim (Identity & Agency):
Personal evolution requires temporal movement. If a person cannot diminish the operational authority of their past, machine memory becomes an inescapable “identity imprisonment.”

The Relational Claim (Shared History):
History is polyphonic and shared. Unilaterally erasing or silencing a memory denies standing to other lives tied to that exact moment.

III. DECOUPLED MEMORY DIMENSIONS MATRIX

Commission 05 established that ordinary memory systems collapse complex state into a binary flag. A humane architecture treats each variable independently:

DIMENSION	CORE QUESTION	ARCHIVAL PRINCIPLE & MECHANICS
TRUTH	Was the representation supported?	Supported in the past does not imply true now. Truth alone does not dictate visibility.
TIME	When was it supported?	Preserves chronological context while allowing present relevance to evolve.
AUTHORITY	What may it influence now?	Controls active behavioral permission in AI summaries, context, and recommendations.
VISIBILITY	Who may encounter it?	Visibility is power. Quiet or background storage is distinct from deletion.
CONSENT	May it continue to be retained?	Privacy status and epistemic status are separate; data can be true yet privately withdrawn.
PROVENANCE	Where did it originate?	Identifies whether failure occurred in model inference, synthesis, or source data.
CONTESTATION	Who disputes it, and on what grounds?	Supports active human standing: <i>affirm, dispute, supersede, contextualize, withdraw.</i>
STAKE	Who else is implicated?	Recognizes multi-party standing over shared relational history.
PROMINENCE	How loudly is it foregrounded?	Allows visual and structural fading without requiring history to lie.
REVISION	How has its status changed?	Treats correction itself as a claim that must remain open to audit and review.

IV. PHILOSOPHICAL RESIDUE

“A scar should record change, not preserve injury.”

“Archival existence does not imply present authority.”

“A scar you gave yourself heals differently, morally, than a scar you gave someone else.”

“The scar belongs to the archive where the representation failed — not automatically to the person represented.”

“Humane memory is not memory that never changes. It is memory whose authority can change without requiring history to lie.”

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